

2.2 WATER CONSERVATION

Council is strongly committed to conserving water and improving water quality, in order to enhance water security under climate change, protect our waterways and support cooling and greening in Waverley.

Residential developments should implement measures to actively reduce potable water consumption. Residential water conservation measures are required under the State Environmental Planning Policy (Building Sustainable Index: BASIX) 2004.

Objectives

- (a) To encourage sustainable water use practices.
- (b) To reduce the use of potable water.
- (c) To encourage on-site water detention to prevent wastewater and runoff from entering waterways.

Controls

- (a) Rainwater tanks connected to outdoor use and toilets and laundry are strongly encouraged for all residential developments.
- (b) Rain tanks must be fitted with a first-flush device that causes initial run-off rainwater to bypass the tank, and
- (c) Rain tanks must be fitted with a screened rain head designed to prevent leaf litter entering into the water tank, and
- (d) Leaf-shedding grills fitted over gutters and downpipes to increase efficiency of rainwater collection are encouraged, and
- (e) All rainwater tanks plumbed for internal water use must have a filter installed to prevent sediment from entering toilets and washing machines, and
- (f) Pumps attached to the development must be housed in an enclosure that is soundproofed, and
- (g) Rain tanks must have its overflow connected to an existing stormwater drainage system that does not discharge to an adjoining property, or cause a nuisance to adjoining owners
- (h) Rain tanks must have a sign affixed to it stating the water in it is rainwater

Design Guidance

For more information about rainwater tanks and water conservation refer to:

<http://www.yourhome.gov.au/water/rainwater>